Packaging & Labeling Guide

Document HPL-OPS-005 | Version 1.8 | Effective April 1, 2026 | Owner: Warehouse Operations

1. Purpose

Correct packaging protects freight, keeps docks safe and avoids extra charges. This guide sets the packaging and labeling standards for all freight shipped from or received at Harbor & Pine Logistics facilities. Freight that does not meet these standards may be refused (HPL-OPS-002, Section 4.4) or charged accessorial fees.

2. Pallet Standards

2.1 **Footprint.** Use standard 48 x 40 inch pallets in good condition, without broken boards or protruding nails.

2.2 **Height and weight.** A loaded pallet must not exceed 72 inches in height (including the pallet) or 2,500 lb gross weight.

2.3 **Overhang.** Cartons must not overhang the pallet edges.

2.4 **Build.** Stack heavier cartons on the bottom and lighter cartons on top, in an interlocking pattern where possible. Mixed-SKU pallets must keep each SKU together and label the pallet "MIXED".

2.5 **Securing.** Stretch-wrap every pallet with at least five full turns, wrapping around the pallet base to tie the load to the pallet. Use corner boards for loads over 1,000 lb.

2.6 **Oversize pallets.** Pallets exceeding the dimensions in Section 2.1 or 2.2 are charged an oversize pallet fee of $40.00 per pallet. Pallets exceeding the limits by more than 10% may be refused.

3. Parcel Standards

3.1 **Weight and size.** A single parcel may weigh up to 150 lb and measure up to 108 inches in length. Heavier or longer items must ship LTL on a pallet.

3.2 **Cartons.** Use new corrugated cartons. Cartons containing more than 40 lb must be double-wall corrugated.

3.3 **Void fill.** Fill empty space so contents cannot shift; a sealed carton should not collapse when lightly pressed on top.

3.4 **Sealing.** Seal with pressure-sensitive plastic tape at least 2 inches wide using the H-taping method. Do not use string, masking tape or cellophane tape.

4. Labeling

4.1 **Shipping label.** Every parcel and pallet carries a shipping label showing the HPL shipment ID (SH-NNNNN), consignee name and address, number of handling units (for example "1 of 4") and the carrier.

4.2 **Pallet labels.** Pallets carry labels on 2 adjacent sides so they can be scanned from either side of the trailer.

4.3 **Barcodes.** Pallets use an SSCC-18 barcode (GS1-128). Parcels use the carrier's barcode plus the HPL shipment ID in Code 128.

4.4 **Handling marks.** Use orientation arrows ("This Side Up") on all cartons containing liquids, and "Fragile" marks only where contents are genuinely fragile.

4.5 **Old labels.** Remove or completely cover old labels and barcodes before reusing cartons.

5. Hazardous Materials Packaging

5.1 Hazmat must be packed in UN-specification packaging appropriate to the material and packing group.

5.2 Each hazmat package carries the proper shipping name, UN number and hazard class label. Lithium battery shipments carry the lithium battery mark or Class 9 label as required by HPL-EHS-004, Section 3.

5.3 Hazmat pallets must be labeled on all four sides.

6. Common Rejection Reasons

Problem	Consequence
Pallet over 72 in or over 2,500 lb	Oversize fee, or refusal if more than 10% over
Missing or unreadable shipping label	Held at dock until relabeled
Damaged or leaking hazmat package	Refused (HPL-EHS-004, Section 8)
Parcel over 150 lb	Converted to LTL at LTL rates